



STEADY BURN

Forging A Stronger Purposeful Man

FIRE - FURNACE - FORGE

STRIKE Worksheet Guided Process

Introduction: Your Routine Is the Shape of Your Discipline

This worksheet is not asking you to dream about a better life. It is asking you to inspect the life you already repeated this week.

That matters because your daily routine is not neutral. It is either helping you become harder to distract, harder to discourage, and easier to trust, or it is training you to drift. Most men do not lose their standards all at once. They lose them in normal hours. A slow morning. A lazy lunch. A weak hour after work. A late night that steals the next day. A phone beside the bed. A workout that keeps getting “moved” until it disappears.

You are not using this worksheet to shame yourself. Shame does not build structure. You are using it to see the surface you are standing on. In the forge, the Anvil is the stable surface where shaping happens. In your life, your routine is that surface. If the day is unstable, your effort scatters. If the day is clear, your effort has somewhere to land.

The goal is simple: inspect one real day, name the weak block, replace it with a better action, protect one strong block, and test the new routine for seven days.

Do not try to fix your whole life in one sitting. That is how men hide inside planning. Fix one weak point. Strengthen one strong point. Then run the change long enough to prove it works.

Use the STRIKE process one letter at a time.

S: Survey the Full Day

The first step is to look at your day without editing it. You are not writing the day you wish you had. You are writing the day you actually lived.

Start with the time you woke up. End with the time you went to sleep. Move hour by hour. Write down what happened in plain words. Include the parts that seem boring, because boring parts often hold the pattern. Work, meals, commute, chores, phone use, family time, rest, training, errands, and wasted time all count.

Do not make the worksheet neat at the cost of truth. A clean lie is still a lie. If you scrolled for 45 minutes in bed, write it. If lunch turned into a long screen break, write it. If you planned to train and did not, write it. This is not a court case. It is an inspection.

How to fill this section

- Write each hour or time block in order.
- Use simple labels: work, commute, food, family, training, phone, rest, chores, sleep, wasted time.
- Add short notes when the block mattered: “focused,” “dragging,” “avoided task,” “felt rushed,” “lost time,” “good energy.”
- Be specific enough that you can see the pattern later.
- Include the start and end of the day, because mornings and nights often control everything else.

Avoid answers like this

- “Worked all day.”
- “Relaxed.”
- “Wasted time.”
- “Did normal stuff.”
- “Had a bad evening.”
- “Was busy.”

These answers are too vague. They do not give you anything to fix.

Answers that work better

- “6:30 to 7:15, stayed in bed scrolling.”
- “8:00 to 11:00, focused work, finished report.”
- “12:00 to 1:20, lunch, then YouTube.”
- “5:30 to 7:00, got home, sat on couch, skipped gym.”
- “8:00 to 8:45, dinner with family, no phone, good conversation.”
- “10:30 to 12:00, watched shows, slept late.”

When you finish this section, you should be able to see your day from a distance. You should know where your energy went, where it was protected, and where it leaked.

T: Tag Each Time Block

Now you stop treating every hour as equal.

Some time blocks move your life forward. Some keep life running. Some weaken the day. Your job is to tag each block honestly. This turns the worksheet from a diary into a tool.

Use three tags: high-value, neutral, and low-value.

High-value blocks are the parts of the day that build the man you want to become. These may include focused work, training, prayer, reading, planning, sleep, meal prep, time with your wife, time with your kids, skill practice, or hard conversations handled well.

Neutral blocks are basic life maintenance. These may include commuting, cleaning, errands, eating, showering, and normal tasks that do not directly build the goal but must be done.

Low-value blocks are the leaks. These are the places where time gets spent but nothing useful is built. Not all rest is low-value. Real rest restores you. Low-value time leaves you duller, later, more irritated, or more behind.

How to fill this section

- Mark each block with H for high-value, N for neutral, or L for low-value.
- Use H when the block supports your goals, values, body, work, family, faith, craft, or recovery.
- Use N when the block is basic life upkeep.
- Use L when the block steals time, lowers energy, delays action, or feeds avoidance.
- Add one short reason beside each L block so you know why it is a leak.
- Add one short reason beside each H block so you know what to protect.

Avoid answers like this

- Calling everything “high-value” because you were busy.
- Calling all rest “low-value” because you think rest is weakness.
- Calling phone time “neutral” when it clearly delayed sleep or work.
- Calling family time “high-value” when you were present in body but not in attention.
- Tagging based on what sounded good instead of what actually happened.

Answers that work better

- “6:30 to 7:15, phone in bed, L, started distracted.”
- “8:00 to 10:00, focused project work, H, best output of day.”

- “12:00 to 12:30, lunch, N, basic meal.”
- “12:30 to 1:10, social media, L, avoided returning to work.”
- “5:30 to 6:15, workout, H, cleared stress and protected health.”
- “10:00 to 10:30, reading before bed, H, helped sleep.”

When you finish this section, you should see the truth: not every full hour is a useful hour. A full day can still be weak if the wrong blocks are leading it.

R: Remove the Weakest Leak

Now you choose one low-value block to cut, limit, or improve.

This is where most men make the mistake of trying to fix everything. They look at the worksheet and see five problems. Then they make ten rules. By Wednesday, the rules are dead.

Do not do that.

Pick one weak link. One block. One leak. Choose the one that causes the most damage. It may not be the longest block. It may be the block that ruins the next block. For example, the first 30 minutes on the phone may not seem huge, but it may set a distracted tone for the whole day. Late-night shows may not seem major, but they may steal sleep, weaken the morning, and damage the next workout.

The weak link is the block that costs more than time. It costs energy, focus, sleep, patience, respect, or follow-through.

How to fill this section

- Choose one low-value time block from your tags.
- Write the exact time it happens.
- Write what usually triggers it.
- Write what it costs you.
- Write one realistic rule to cut it, limit it, or change it.
- Keep the rule simple enough to follow when tired.

Avoid answers like this

- “I need to stop wasting time.”
- “I should be more disciplined.”

- “I need to use my phone less.”
- “I will stop being lazy after work.”
- “I am going to fix my whole evening routine.”

These answers sound serious, but they are too broad. They do not tell you what to do when the moment arrives.

Answers that work better

- “Weak block: 6:30 to 7:15 AM, phone in bed.”
- “Trigger: alarm goes off and phone is already in my hand.”
- “Cost: distracted start, late shower, rushed morning.”
- “Rule: phone charges in kitchen. Alarm clock goes beside bed.”

Or:

- “Weak block: 5:45 to 7:00 PM, couch after work.”
- “Trigger: I walk in tired and sit down before changing clothes.”
- “Cost: skipped workout, low energy, poor mood.”
- “Rule: change into gym clothes before sitting down.”

Or:

- “Weak block: 10:30 PM to midnight, shows.”
- “Trigger: I say I need to unwind.”
- “Cost: poor sleep, bad morning, skipped prayer and planning.”
- “Rule: TV off at 10:15. In bed with book by 10:30.”

When you finish this section, you should have one clear leak and one clear rule. Not a mood. Not a wish. A rule.

I: Install a Better Replacement

A weak block cannot just be removed. It must be replaced.

Empty space gets filled by old habits. If you only say, “I will stop scrolling,” your hand will still reach for the phone when the cue hits. If you only say, “I will stop watching so much TV,” the evening will

still feel open and your brain will look for the same reward. You need a better action ready before the old action starts.

The replacement does not need to be heroic. In fact, it should not be heroic. It should be simple, repeatable, and close to the same time block. The goal is to give the day a new track to run on.

A good replacement does one of three things: it moves your body, clears your mind, or prepares the next block.

How to fill this section

- Write the old action.
- Write the new action.
- Write when the new action will happen.
- Write where it will happen.
- Write what needs to be ready before the moment comes.
- Make the replacement small enough to repeat for seven days.

Avoid answers like this

- “Instead of scrolling, I will become productive.”
- “Instead of TV, I will work on my purpose.”
- “Instead of eating junk, I will be healthy.”
- “Instead of wasting time, I will do something better.”
- “Instead of skipping the gym, I will transform my body.”

These answers are too big. They sound strong but give no next move.

Answers that work better

- “Old action: scrolling in bed.”
- “New action: get up, drink water, take a 10-minute walk.”
- “When: right after alarm.”
- “Where: kitchen, then outside.”
- “Setup: phone charges in kitchen, walking shoes by door.”

Or:

- “Old action: couch after work.”
- “New action: change clothes and walk for 20 minutes.”
- “When: within 10 minutes of getting home.”
- “Where: neighborhood.”
- “Setup: shoes and clothes placed by the bedroom door.”

Or:

- “Old action: YouTube during lunch.”
- “New action: eat, then take a 10-minute walk or read 5 pages.”
- “When: after lunch.”
- “Where: outside or break room.”
- “Setup: book in bag, headphones left at desk.”

Or:

- “Old action: late-night shows.”
- “New action: shower, lay out clothes, read 10 pages.”
- “When: 10:15 PM.”
- “Where: bedroom.”
- “Setup: book on nightstand, TV remote in drawer.”

When you finish this section, your answer should tell you exactly what to do in the old danger zone. You are not trusting your mood anymore. You are giving the hour a new job.

K: Keep the Strongest Block Protected

Do not only look for what is broken. Look for what is working.

A good routine audit should reveal your strongest block. This is the part of the day where you are most focused, most steady, most useful, or most aligned. It may be early morning. It may be a training block. It may be dinner with your family. It may be the first 90 minutes at work. It may be a quiet hour at night when the house is still.

Most men make the mistake of letting strong blocks get invaded. They put email into their best thinking time. They let work messages enter dinner. They place workouts in a time slot that always gets attacked. They treat their best hour like it is common, then wonder why their output drops.

This section of the worksheet is about defense. You are going to name one strong block and protect it on purpose.

How to fill this section

- Choose one high-value block from your tags.
- Write what makes that block strong.
- Write what usually threatens it.
- Write one boundary that protects it.
- Write one way to amplify it, even slightly.
- Keep the protection realistic and clear.

Avoid answers like this

- “My whole morning is strong.”
- “I just need to stay focused.”
- “Family time matters.”
- “Workouts are important.”
- “I should protect my time better.”

These answers are true, but they are too soft. They do not create protection.

Answers that work better

- “Strong block: 8:00 to 10:00 AM focused work.”
- “Why it works: best mental energy, fewer interruptions.”
- “Threat: checking email before deep work.”
- “Protection: no email until 10:00 AM.”
- “Amplify: prepare task list the night before.”

Or:

- “Strong block: 6:00 to 6:45 AM training.”

- “Why it works: starts day with discipline.”
- “Threat: sleeping late because bedtime is loose.”
- “Protection: lights out by 10:30 PM.”
- “Amplify: clothes and water bottle set out before bed.”

Or:

- “Strong block: 6:30 PM dinner with family.”
- “Why it works: keeps me present at home.”
- “Threat: work texts and email.”
- “Protection: phone on charger in another room during dinner.”
- “Amplify: ask one real question at the table each night.”

Or:

- “Strong block: Sunday meal prep.”
- “Why it works: keeps food choices clean during the week.”
- “Threat: waiting until too late Sunday.”
- “Protection: grocery trip before noon.”
- “Amplify: prep two extra lunches.”

When you finish this section, you should know what part of your day already has heat in it. Your job is to stop letting the wrong things steal it.

E: Evaluate After Seven Days

The final letter is where the lesson becomes real.

You are not finished when the worksheet is filled out. You are finished when the adjusted routine has been tested in the real world. A plan that only works on paper is not a routine. It is decoration.

Run the change for seven days. Keep it simple. You are testing one removed leak and one protected strong block. Each day, mark whether you followed the rule. Also note what changed. Did you sleep better? Did you train more? Did you waste less time? Did your mornings feel less rushed? Did your work improve? Did your family get more of your attention?

The goal is not to feel inspired. The goal is to gather proof.

After seven days, decide what stays, what changes, and what gets removed. This is how a man builds a routine that works. He does not worship the first plan. He tests it, learns from it, and tightens it.

How to fill this section

- Track the change for seven days.
- Mark each day as kept, missed, or adjusted.
- Write one sentence about what helped.
- Write one sentence about what made it hard.
- Write what changed in your output, sleep, focus, training, family time, or mood.
- Decide the next version of the routine.

Avoid answers like this

- “It went pretty well.”
- “I need to keep trying.”
- “I failed a few days.”
- “I felt better.”
- “I will do better next week.”

These answers do not show proof. They do not tell you what to keep or change.

Answers that work better

- “Kept the phone out of the bedroom 5 of 7 days.”
- “Morning started faster on the days I kept the rule.”
- “Missed Tuesday and Friday because I stayed up too late.”
- “The replacement walk worked because shoes were ready.”
- “Dinner was stronger 4 nights because the phone stayed in the kitchen.”
- “Next change: TV off at 10:15 so the phone rule is easier in the morning.”

Or:

- “Changed clothes before sitting down 6 of 7 workdays.”
- “Worked out 4 times instead of 2.”
- “Hardest day was Wednesday because I came home hungry.”

- “Meal prep would help the after-work block.”
- “Next change: protein snack before leaving work.”

Or:

- “No email before 10:00 AM worked 4 of 5 workdays.”
- “Finished more deep work before lunch.”
- “Problem: I forgot to tell my team.”
- “Next change: set status message from 8:00 to 10:00 AM.”

When you finish this section, you should not just know what happened. You should know what to do next.

Closing Direction: Make the Day Hold

This worksheet is not about becoming a man who never wastes time. That man does not exist. It is about becoming a man who notices the leak, owns the leak, and repairs the leak before it becomes his life.

The routine is the Anvil. It is the surface where your choices land. If the surface is weak, your effort scatters. If the surface is stable, small actions begin to shape you.

Do not leave this as an exercise. Pick the weak block. Cut it. Install the replacement. Protect the strong block. Evaluate the proof after seven days.

Your next week will either repeat your old pattern or start training a new one. The worksheet will not choose. You will.